

MEDIEVAL

Paper 1: Medicine Through Time with the Western Front

Name:

Class:

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: KT1.1: What did Medieval people believe caused illness?			
L2: KT1.2: How did Medieval people try to prevent and treat disease?			
L3: KT1.3: How did people respond to the Black Death?			
Final Unit Grade:			

L1: KT1.1: What did Medieval people believe caused illness?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain how supernatural and religious factors influenced beliefs about the cause of illness.
- ☐ Analyse the rational, natural theories of disease used in medieval England.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

1. What does the term 'public health' refer to?

2. Name one ancient civilization that influenced later medical ideas.

3. Why was the Catholic Church so powerful in the Middle Ages?

4. Explain how religion might both help and hinder medical progress.

5. To what extent were ancient ideas like those of Hippocrates still influential in c1250?

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

Miasma | Four Humours | Theory of Opposites

In medieval England, medical beliefs were heavily dominated by ancient theories rather than scientific observation. Under the popular _____ theory, a patient's temperature or cold was diagnosed as a bodily imbalance. To treat a cold, a physician might use Galen's _____ to recommend eating hot and dry spices. However, when entire towns fell ill, people often blamed _____, believing that foul-smelling air from rotting waste in the streets was poisoning their lungs.

Q1. Identify one reason why the Church promoted Galen's ideas.

Q2. Describe the Theory of the Four Humours.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK (Q3)

Why did the Church promote the work of the ancient Roman doctor Galen?

- ☐ A. Because Galen proved that God sent diseases as a punishment.
 - ☐ B. Because Galen's theory of a perfectly designed body fit Christian creation theology.
 - ☐ C. Because Galen was a devout Christian.
 - ☐ D. Because he was the personal physician to the Pope.
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Q4. Explain how astrology was used in medieval medicine.

Q5. Evaluate the significance of the Church in holding back medical progress in the Middle Ages.

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: Which factor was the most powerful barrier to medieval medical progress: the absolute authority of the Christian Church, or the logical appeal of the Theory of the Four Humours?

Think: Jot down your choice and one piece of evidence from the sources (e.g., Church control of universities/libraries, or how symptoms like sneezing phlegm seemed to prove the humours existed).

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

Exam Q1. 'The Theory of the Four Humours was the main idea about the cause of disease in the Middle Ages'. How far do you agree? Explain your answer. (16 marks) You may use the following in your answer:

- Galen
- the Church

You must also use information of your own.

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TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

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Lined area for student response.

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

Exam Q3. Explain why there was so little change in ideas about the cause of disease in the years c.1250-c.1500. (12 marks)

You may use the following in your answer:

- The Church
- Galen

You must also use information of your own.

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General Notes

L2: KT1.2: How did Medieval people try to prevent and treat disease?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain the connection between medieval beliefs about disease and their approaches to treatment and prevention.
- ☐ Evaluate the roles, training, and accessibility of different medical healers in medieval society.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 6

1. Which Ancient Greek physician originally created the Theory of the Four Humours?

2. How did the Church explain the cause of disease?

3. What was 'miasma'?

4. Why did the Church promote the ideas of Galen?

5. Explain why astrology was used to diagnose illness in the medieval period.

6. Recall: Who was Roger Bacon and what was their key contribution to medicine?

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Phlebotomy | Regimen Sanitatis | Theriaca

Your Sentence:

Q1. Identify one supernatural method used to prevent disease.

Q2. Describe the process of bloodletting.

Q3. Explain how the Theory of Opposites was used in treatments.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK (Q4)

What was the main difference between an apothecary and a physician?

- ☐ A. Physicians performed surgery, apothecaries diagnosed illness.
- ☐ B. Apothecaries mixed herbal remedies based on experience, while physicians diagnosed using astrology and ancient books.
- ☐ C. Apothecaries were trained at university, physicians were not.
- ☐ D. Physicians were always monks, apothecaries were always women.

Q5. To what extent were medieval treatments dangerous for patients?

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: If you were a medieval peasant, who would you trust more to care for your family: an expensive university-trained physician who diagnosed using urine and star charts, or a female family member treating you in the home with herbal remedies?

Think: Jot down your choice and one piece of evidence from the sources (such as the Paston family letters showing deep distrust of professional physicians, or the fact that women treated families for free with garden herbs like marigolds and clover).

Your Notes:

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Blank lined paper for writing.

Handwriting practice lines consisting of 28 horizontal blue lines.

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TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

Exam Q5. Explain why there was little change in the care provided by hospitals in the period c.1250-c.1500. (12 marks)

You may use the following in your answer:

- Monks and nuns
- infectious diseases

You must also use information of your own.

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General Notes

L3: KT1.3: How did people respond to the Black Death?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain the religious and supernatural responses to the Black Death.
- ☐ Analyse the rational and governmental methods used to prevent and treat the plague.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 6

1. Name one religious treatment used in the medieval period.

2. What was the purpose of 'bleeding' or 'purging'?

3. Who were the 'flagellants'?

4. Explain the role of the apothecary in medieval medicine.

5. How effective were medieval hospitals at treating disease?

6. Recall: Who was Roger Bacon and what was their key contribution to medicine?

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **Buboes**

Q1. Identify the true cause of the Black Death.

Q2. Describe two ways people tried to prevent the Black Death.

Q3. Explain why the government's response to the Black Death failed.

Q4. Evaluate the impact of the Black Death on medieval society.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK (Q5)

Why were the government's orders to clean the streets completely ineffective at stopping the Black Death?

- ☐ A. Because the peasants refused to obey the King's laws.
- ☐ B. Because the disease was actually a punishment from God.
- ☐ C. Because they were trying to remove bad smells (miasma), but ignored the rats and fleas that actually spread the disease.
- ☐ D. Because the dirt on the streets was actually killing the germs.

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: Was the medieval response to the Black Death dominated more by desperate spiritual panic or by logical, rational attempts at disease prevention based on the scientific ideas of the time?

Think: Jot down your choice and one piece of evidence (e.g., the public whipping of the flagellants vs. mayors ordering rakers to clear dung and waste from the streets to stop bad air).

Your Notes:

- bloodletting
- dissection

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TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

Exam Q7. Explain why the Black Death spread so rapidly in Britain in 1348. (12 marks)

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TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

Exam Q8. 'The main reason why medical care and treatment was ineffective during the medieval period (c1250-c1500) was because medical knowledge was based on Galen's ideas.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer. (16 marks + 4 marks for SPaG) (16 marks)

You may use the following in your answer:

- The Four Humours
- The Black Death

You must also use information of your own.

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General Notes

Factors Overview: Medieval

Edexcel focuses heavily on the factors that drove medical progress (or held it back). For each factor below, write one specific historical example from this period that either helped or hindered medical progress.

Factor	Specific Historical Example & Impact
Individuals	
The Church & Religion	
Government & Wealth	
Science & Technology	
Attitudes in Society	
War	

